



Family Financial Safety Guide

A practical handbook for spouses, parents and children of serving personnel, veterans and defence civilians.

WHY MILITARY FAMILIES ARE TARGETED

Fraud networks deliberately profile defence families: postings keep the serving member away from home, pay and pension credits arrive on predictable dates, and families trust anyone who speaks the language of the fauj - unit names, ranks, CSD, ECHS and welfare funds. Scammers weaponise that trust.

Golden rule: No bank, no army office, no welfare fund and no government portal will EVER ask for an OTP, UPI PIN, CVV or password on a call. The moment anyone asks - it is fraud.

HOUSEHOLD SECURITY DRILLS

1. Set a family code word. Any caller claiming an emergency involving your soldier must be verified with the code word and a call-back to the unit line.
2. Keep the unit adjutant / record office numbers written next to the phone, not just saved in one mobile.
3. Enable transaction alerts and daily limits on every family bank account and UPI app.
4. Never scan a QR code to RECEIVE money. QR + PIN always means money is LEAVING.
5. Review pension and salary account statements together on a fixed day every month.
6. Do not share deployment details, rank, unit or family photos on public social media.
7. Verify every 'army buyer' or 'army seller' on resale apps - refuse advance payments.

IF MONEY LEAVES THE ACCOUNT

1. Call 1930 (National Cyber Crime Helpline) immediately - the first 60 minutes are the Golden Window while funds are still in transit.
2. File a complaint on cybercrime.gov.in with screenshots, numbers and UPI IDs.
3. Call the bank's official fraud line and freeze the card / UPI handle.
4. Inform the serving member's unit and the local police (dial 112).
5. Do not delete anything - messages, call logs and receipts are evidence.

TALK ABOUT IT

A large share of cases are never reported because victims feel embarrassed. Fraud is a crime committed against you, not a mistake you made. Reporting fast protects your money and protects the next family on the scammer's list.